

B2 DIAGNOSTIC SESSION — TEACHER GUIDE

> **For the new B2 teacher.** This is a 2-hour diagnostic session with 5 students. Goal: meet each student, see their real level, detect strengths and weaknesses, and submit a written report to coordination so the next classes can be tailored.

> **Why this session matters:** the previous teacher didn't follow Heiiu guides. We don't have reliable data on this cohort. You're rebuilding the picture in 2 hours. The students don't need to know this — for them, it's "the new teacher getting to know us."

> **Important:** Don't correct grammar today. Just observe. Take notes during each round. The goal is **data**, not teaching.

SESSION OVERVIEW

| Round | Time | Activity | What you observe |

|---|---|---|---|

| 1 | 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + Personal intros (30 sec each) | First impression, fluency, accent |

| 2 | 0:10–0:35 | Round 1 — Personal Story Presentations (4-5 min each) | Vocabulary, narrative skills, grammar in context |

| 3 | 0:35–1:05 | Round 2 — Hot Topic Debate (paired, against each other) | Argumentation, fluency under pressure, listening |

| 4 | 1:05–1:35 | Round 3 — Professional Mini-Pitch | Structure, persuasion, professional vocabulary |

| 5 | 1:35–1:50 | Round 4 — Group Discussion (open) | Group dynamics, weakest moments, motivation |

| 6 | 1:50–2:00 | Closing + Quick announcement | Set tone for next class |

Total: 120 minutes (2 hours). No break — the session needs to flow continuously.

BEFORE THE SESSION (15 min prep)

- [] **Bring the printed `REPORTE\_DIAGNOSTICO\_COHORTE\_B2.pdf`** (you'll fill it by hand after the session).
- [] Bring a separate clean sheet of paper for **quick notes during the session** (1 page per student is ideal — write the student's name at the top of each).
- [] Bring your error paper + a couple of pens. **Don't correct out loud. Just write.**
- [] Set up the room: chairs in a U-shape (or circle) so everyone can see each other.
- [] Phone face-down. No notifications.

> **Important:** during the session you won't have a computer — only paper and pen. Write quickly and shorthand. After the session, transfer your shorthand notes into the printed report (5 student pages + group summary).

ROUND 1 — WELCOME + PERSONAL INTROS (10 min)

The first 10 minutes set the tone for everything else.

> **Walk in confident, smile, sit at the head of the U. ENGLISH ONLY from minute 1.**

Say:

> "Hey everyone, great to finally meet you. I'm [your name]. I'll be your teacher from this week onward. **Today is a little different** — I'm not going to teach you anything new today. **I want to get to know you, hear how you speak English, and understand where each of you is right now.** That helps me design the next classes specifically for this group.

>

> Let's start with something simple. We're going to go around the room. Each of you, in **30 seconds**, tell me:

> 1. Your name

> 2. What you do (work / studies)

> 3. Why you're learning English

>

> Just 30 seconds. Quick. I'll start."

You go first — 30 sec example. Show what you want.

Then go around: each student talks 30 sec.

While they talk, mentally note:

- How fluent are they in 30 seconds?
 - Do they sound nervous?
 - Are they at B2 level or below?
 - Any obvious accent issues?
-

ROUND 2 — PERSONAL STORY PRESENTATIONS (25 min)

Setup (1 min):

> "Now let's go a bit deeper. Each of you will speak for **4 to 5 minutes** about one of these topics. Pick whichever fits you best:

>

> 1. **The hardest professional or academic challenge you've faced.** What was it, what did you do, what happened?

> 2. **A trip or experience that changed how you see life.** Where, why, what changed?

> 3. **Something you've achieved that you're proud of.** Why does it matter to you?

>

> You have **2 minutes to think**. Use that time. Then we go around. After each person finishes, the rest of you ask **one question**. Ready? Two minutes. Go."

Preparation (2 min): Silence. Let them think. Don't interrupt. Walk around discreetly.

Presentations (5 min × 5 students = 25 min):

For each student:

1. They speak ~4 min.
2. Other students ask 1 question each (4 questions × 30 sec = 2 min, but be flexible).
3. **You don't ask questions yet.** Just observe.
4. Move to next student smoothly: "Thanks, [name]. Who wants to go next?" or pick.

During each presentation, write quick notes in your sheet:

| What to track | How to mark |

|---|---|

| Pronunciation issues | Underline words mispronounced |

| Vocabulary range | "Limited" / "Good" / "Excellent" |

| Fluency | "Fluent" / "Pauses often" / "Struggles" |

| Grammar errors (don't fix, just note) | "Verb tense issues", "Article problems", etc. |

| Body language / confidence | "Confident" / "Nervous" / "Engaged" |

| Stand-out moments | Quote a word/phrase that surprised you (positively or negatively) |

> **Pro tip:** the question they ASK each other is as informative as their own presentation. If their question is shallow ("How was the trip?"), they're at B1+. If it's nuanced ("What was the moment when you knew you wouldn't quit?"), they're at B2+.

ROUND 3 — HOT TOPIC DEBATE (30 min)

Setup (3 min):

Write the topic on the board:

"AI tools like ChatGPT will replace at least 30% of professional jobs in the next 10 years. Some say this is good (more leisure, less work). Others say this is a disaster (no income, no purpose, social collapse).

Where do YOU stand? Defend with examples."

> "We'll do a structured debate. **Side A** says 'good.' **Side B** says 'disaster.' I'm going to assign sides — even if you don't agree with your side, **defend it**. That's the challenge.

>

> [Pair students up]: [Student 1 + 2] are Side A. [Student 3 + 4] are Side B. [Student 5] is the **judge** — you listen and tell us at the end who argued more clearly.

>

> You have **5 minutes** to prepare with your partner. Build your strongest 2 arguments. Then we debate."

Preparation (5 min): Pairs prepare. Walk around. Listen to the prep itself — that's data. Are they cooperating? Building on each other?

Debate format (20 min):

| Phase | Time | What happens |

|---|---|---|

| Side A opening (90 sec each) | 3 min | Both Side A speakers present |

| Side B response | 3 min | Both Side B speakers respond |

| Side A counter | 3 min | Side A defends, attacks Side B |

| Side B final | 3 min | Side B defends, attacks Side A |

| Open debate | 5 min | Free exchange, anyone can jump in |

| Judge verdict | 3 min | Judge says who argued more clearly and why |

During debate, observe:

| What to track | Why it matters |

|---|---|

| Who attacks vs who defends? | Aggressive vs cautious personality |

| Who uses connectors? (however, on the other hand, etc.) | B2 marker |

| Who repeats arguments vs builds new ones? | Argumentation skill |

| Who manages emotions? | Emotional intelligence under stress |

| Who uses concrete examples? | Critical thinking |

| Who falls into Spanish? | Real fluency limit |

The judge's verdict is telling. A good B2 judge gives nuanced reasoning. A weak one says "I liked Side A more."

ROUND 4 — PROFESSIONAL MINI-PITCH (30 min)

Setup (1 min):

> "Last big activity. Each of you will give a **3-minute professional pitch**: 'If you had to pitch your dream business idea or career move to a real investor or boss — what would it be?' Real or fantasy, doesn't matter. The point is **structure, persuasion, and clarity**.

>
> You have **3 minutes to prepare**. Then each of you delivers. After each pitch, I'll ask **one tough question**. Be ready."

Preparation (3 min): Silence. Let them think.

Pitches (3 min each + 1 min question = 4 min × 5 = 20 min):

For each student:

1. They pitch 3 min.
2. **YOU ask one tough question** (1 min). Examples:
 - "What's the biggest risk in your idea, and how would you handle it?"
 - "Why should I invest in you specifically and not someone else?"
 - "What's the first thing you would do tomorrow if I gave you 10 million pesos right now?"
3. They have 1 min to answer.

During pitches, observe:

What to track	Why it matters
Did they have a clear hook?	Marketing/pitch skill
Did they use numbers, data, examples?	Professional vocabulary
Did they finish on time?	Time management + structure
Did they handle YOUR tough question well?	Improvisation under pressure
Did they sound like a leader or a student?	Professional voice

Closing of Round 4 (5 min):

> "Quick group reflection: **Whose pitch surprised you the most?** Don't say nice things — say honest. Why did one of these stick with you?"

Let students nominate each other. This shows you the **internal hierarchy of the group**: who do they respect? Who do they not take seriously yet?

ROUND 5 — GROUP DISCUSSION (15 min)

Setup (1 min):

> "Last conversation. Open. Honest. **What are your biggest challenges with English right now?** Not what you 'should' say — what actually frustrates you. What feels impossible? What do you wish you could do but can't yet?"

>
> No order. Whoever wants to talk, talks. I won't lead. Let it flow."

Let it run (12 min):

- Don't lead. Let them talk to each other.
- If silence falls, wait 10 seconds before stepping in.
- Note who **dominates**, who is **silent**, who **bridges** between others.

> **This round is the most informative for personality dynamics in the cohort.** Within 10 minutes you'll see who's the leader, who's the quiet one with depth, who's afraid, who's faking confidence.

Closing of group discussion (2 min):

> "Thank you. Your honesty here helps me design the next classes."

ROUND 6 — CLOSING + QUICK ANNOUNCEMENT (10 min)

> "Today was a different kind of class — no books, no grammar drills. **Just me listening to you.** I have a clear picture of where each of you is, and what we should work on first.

>
> Starting tomorrow, classes go back to normal — but now I know what's specifically useful for **THIS** group, not a generic plan.

>
> **One thing:** I'm going to write a report tonight to send to coordination, with my honest observations about each of you. **Not for grading — for designing the right next steps.** If you want to know what I wrote about you, ask coordination next week. They'll share it.

>
> Quick question before we close: **One thing you want me to know about how you learn English best?** Anyone."

Let 1-2 students share. Don't push. Close with:

> "Thanks for the energy today. See you tomorrow. Same place, same time. Tomorrow we work."

You stand. They leave. You stay 10 min in silence to write down everything fresh — before notes blur.

AFTER THE SESSION (30-40 min — DON'T SKIP)

Stay in the room (or find a quiet space). Pull out the printed report. Fill it by hand IMMEDIATELY while observations are fresh. If you wait until tomorrow, half the detail is gone.

For each of the 5 students (1 page per student):

- Write the 3 strengths you observed (specific, with examples)
- Write the 3 weaknesses (specific, not generic)

- Rate the 7 dimensions (1-5) with a brief comment each
- Write the best moment quote and worst struggle quote (their words)
- Mark their emotional read
- Write your specific recommendation for what they should work on first
- Note their personal/professional context

Then fill the **group summary** (last 2 pages):

- Group cohesion and dynamics
- Top 3 pedagogical priorities for the next 5 classes
- Alerts for coordination

Submit the filled report to coordination the same day:

- ■ Hand it over physically, OR
- ■ Take a photo of every page and send by WhatsApp, OR
- ■ Scan and email it.

> *The report is paper-based on purpose: it gets archived in coordination's physical file for the cohort. Coordination uses it to design the next class plans.*

NOTES FOR THE TEACHER

What you DON'T do today

- ■ Don't correct grammar. (Tomorrow yes. Today: observe.)
- ■ Don't compare students to each other in front of them.
- ■ Don't say "Your English is good/bad." (Today is data collection, not feedback.)
- ■ Don't promise specific things ("By end of B2 you will speak like a native"). Coordination handles those promises.
- ■ Don't talk about the previous teacher. Period. If a student mentions them, smile and redirect: "What's important is what we build now."

What you DO today

- ■ Listen actively. 80% listening, 20% facilitating.
- ■ Take detailed notes by student.
- ■ Set the tone of confidence and seriousness — these students need to feel they're with a professional.
- ■ End on time. 2 hours, not 2:15.
- ■ Write the report TONIGHT, while observations are sharp.

If something goes wrong

- **A student starts crying or gets defensive:** "Take a moment, no rush. We're not graded today."
 - **A student dominates and others can't speak:** "Great point. [Name], what do you think? I want to hear your side."
 - **A student barely speaks:** Don't pressure. Note it. Address one-on-one in the next class.
 - **The energy dies in Round 3 or 4:** "Stand up. We finish this on our feet." Movement resets the room.
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REGLA DE ORO

The previous teacher built no documentation. **You're rebuilding the cohort's record from scratch in 2 hours.** Every observation you write tonight is the foundation for the next 6 months of B2 classes. Take it seriously.

> *Your report tonight is more valuable than your first 5 lessons combined. It's what makes those lessons worth their cost.*